

Motorola Edge 50

Premium look, limited power

Motorola has unveiled the Motorola Edge 50, aiming to make a splash in the sub-30K mid-range smartphone market. This new addition to the Edge 50 series offers a mix of premium features and a robust build at an appealing price. With its sleek design, capable cameras, and high-end features, the Moto Edge 50 carries forward the Edge 50 family's signature style. Yet, it faces stiff competition from devices like the OnePlus Nord 4 (review), POCO F6 (review), and realme 13 Pro (review). So, does the Motorola Edge 50 deliver on its promises and stand out as the best value in its class? I've tested it thoroughly to see if it lives up to the hype.

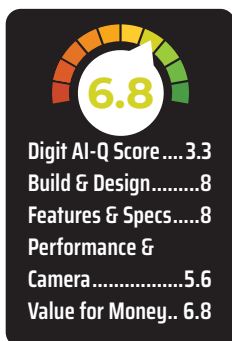
BUILD AND DESIGN

The Motorola Edge 50 stands out in the crowded mid-range market with its sleek and opulent design. Its curved screen and rear panel provide an ergonomic feel, while the stunning vegan leather back enhances its aesthetic appeal. The phone's aluminium frame is a rare find at this price point, making it one of the more premium builds in its segment.

Available in three colours—Koala Gray, Jungle Green, and Peach Fuzz—the Jungle Green variant features a vegan leather back, while the other colours use vegan suede material. The camera module, though protruding, transitions smoothly into the raised area without abrupt lines. I really enjoy the visual identity of the Moto Edge 50 series; it is instantly recognisable.

The phone is protected by Gorilla Glass 5, an upgrade over competitors like the OnePlus Nord 4, which uses Panda Glass. The under-screen fingerprint sensor is both speedy and

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accurate. Additionally, the Edge 50 boasts an IP68 rating for dust and water resistance, allowing it to handle splashes and brief submersions with ease.

At just 7.5mm thick, the Motorola Edge 50 is the slimmest MIL-810H-rated curved smartphone in its segment, offering durability that surpasses

rivals like the Realme 13 Pro and OnePlus Nord 4. This combination of build quality and premium aesthetics makes the Motorola Edge 50 an excellent choice for those seeking a well-built, stylish smartphone.

DISPLAY

The Motorola Edge 50 features a captivating 6.7-inch pOLED display with 120 Hz refresh rate support and 1.5K resolution. With slim bezels and a 92.2% screen-to-body ratio, the phone delivers a nearly edge-to-edge viewing experience.

The display supports HDR10+, which allows for vivid and sharp HDR content with excellent colour reproduc-

tion and viewing angles. The addition of HDR support gives it a leg up over competing products that miss out on HDR, such as the Realme 13 Pro.

Under direct sunlight, the display can achieve a peak brightness of 1162 nits as per our tests, making it highly readable even in bright conditions. The Dolby Atmos stereo speakers further elevate the multimedia experience, providing immersive sound quality that complements the stunning visuals. Whether you're watching videos or playing games, the display and audio combination offers an engaging and enjoyable experience.

PERFORMANCE, UI, AND AI

Powering the Motorola Edge 50 is the Snapdragon 7 Gen 1 Accelerated Edition, a chipset that aims to balance performance with efficiency. It comes with 8 GB of LPDDR4X RAM and 256 GB of UFS 2.2 storage. I'm disappointed that Motorola didn't opt for UFS 3.1 storage, as competitors like the Realme 13 Pro and OnePlus Nord 4 have faster UFS 3.1 speeds.

While the chipset manages everyday tasks efficiently, it struggles with more demanding gaming scenarios. For games like Call of Duty: Mobile and BGMI, it only provides smooth frame rates at Medium settings. Additionally, I noticed some lag in the camera app, though performance is generally smooth in other areas.

In benchmark tests, the Edge 50 lags behind the OnePlus Nord 4 but performs slightly better than the Realme 13 Pro. It falls far behind the OnePlus Nord 4 in AnTuTu and GPU benchmark tests, which indicates that the Nord 4 is a better option for power users and mobile gamers. However, the Edge 50 does exceedingly well in PCMark Work which suggests that it is a great option for productivity-related tasks such as Excel sheets, Google Docs, and more.

On the software front, the Edge 50 runs on Hello UI, Motorola's custom user interface. The UI is modern, bloatware-free, and highly customis-